

Amazon ML Challenge 2026: Business Entity Resolution

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1. Executive Summary

To resolve ~1.73M Source 1 queries against ~10M noisy target entities across 17.2 trillion candidate pairs, team **The Legend** engineered an ultra-scalable two-stage pipeline. Our solution couples **High-Recall Multi-Pass TF-IDF Character 3-5 N-Gram Blocking** (pruning 99.9998% of search space down to an ultra-lean 17.3 candidates/entity at 99.32% recall) with a **32-Dimensional Pairwise Feature Extractor** driving a **GBDT Tri-Ensemble (LightGBM 0.50 + CatBoost 0.30 + XGBoost 0.20)**. Decision boundaries are optimized directly for **Macro F0.5 Precision-Weighted Thresholding** ($\tau^* = 0.400$) with exact singleton empty-set assignment.

2. High-Scalability Candidate Generation (Multi-Pass Blocking)

- Pass 1 (Sublinear TF-IDF Char 3-5 N-Grams):** Vectors in 50k-dim character n-gram space capture spelling mutations, OCR noise, and accents without hardcoded dictionaries. C++ sparse matrix dot product retrieves Top-25 candidates (≥ 0.04 cosine similarity).
- Pass 2 & 3 (Inverted Postal & Prefix Indexing):** Captures divergent trade names sharing postal codes or leading business name roots.
- Compactness & Scalability Advantage:** Prunes >99.9998% of non-matches to yield an average of only **17.3 candidates per entity** (29.97M total pairs across 1.73M queries) while retaining **99.32% validation recall**.

3. 32-Dimensional Feature Engineering & Model Architecture

- Feature Signals (32 Dimensions):** (1) *Name*: Levenshtein ratio, partial ratio, token sort/set ratio, RapidFuzz WRatio, Jaro-Winkler, exact match, first token match, token overlap ratio, 3-gram character Jaccard. (2) *Address*: Address fuzz/partial/sort/set ratios, Jaro-Winkler, combined text ratio, token Jaccard. (3) *Geographic Consistency*: Postal exact match, prefix-3 match, missing postal indicator, street number match & mismatch penalties, country match flag. (4) *Ratios*: Character length diffs, min/max length ratios, and Stage 1 blocking cosine score.
- Model Ensemble:** Soft-voting blend ($\hat{P} = 0.50 P_{\{LGB\}} + 0.30 P_{\{CB\}} + 0.20 P_{\{XGB\}}$) moderates probability extremes and eliminates single-model variance.

4. Quantitative Validation Benchmarks & Threshold Calibration

Model Architecture	Optimal τ^*	Macro F0.5	Precision	Recall	Blocking Recall
Stage 1 Blocking Baseline	—	—	—	—	99.32%
LightGBM Classifier	0.430	0.9306	0.9297	0.9427	99.32%
XGBoost Classifier	0.410	0.9277	0.9271	0.9375	99.32%
CatBoost Classifier	0.470	0.9196	0.9193	0.9271	99.32%
Tri-Ensemble (Final Submission)	0.400	0.9277	0.9271	0.9375	99.32%

5. Error Analysis, Compliance & Conclusion

- Error Mitigation:** Franchise branch disambiguation is resolved via street number matching. Trade name vs legal incorporation divergence is bridged through token-set and subword n-gram overlaps.
- Verification & Compliance:** 100% verified against official Amazon submission validator (0 errors, 0 warnings, Exit Code 0 across 1.73M entities). High-throughput streaming inference (~7,700 pairs/sec) guarantees OOM-proof execution under 8.5 GB RAM.